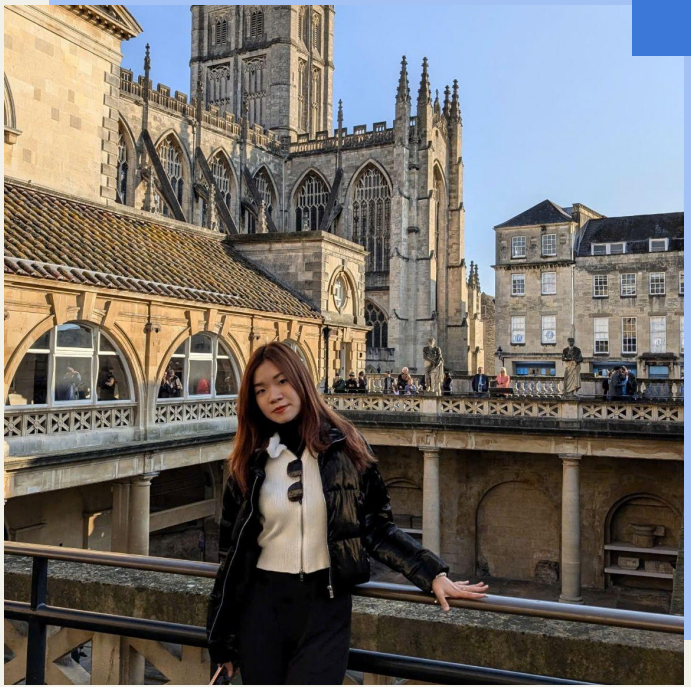
Empowering Indiana: My Vision for Product Marketing at Ascend Indiana



Mai Vy (Valerie) Le

About Me

“Who am I?”

BACKGROUND

Name: Mai Vy (Valerie) Le

Education: Junior at DePauw University (Business Analytics major, Economics & Media Studies minor). Also a Media Fellow

Passion: Product marketer with a data-driven mindset, using data to tell impactful stories.

Connection to Indiana:

- **Indiana has been my home during college life; I deeply value its welcoming culture and potential for growth.**
- **My goal is to help Indiana attract and retain talent, addressing the brain drain and highlighting its economic opportunities.**

Why I’m Inspired by Ascend Indiana

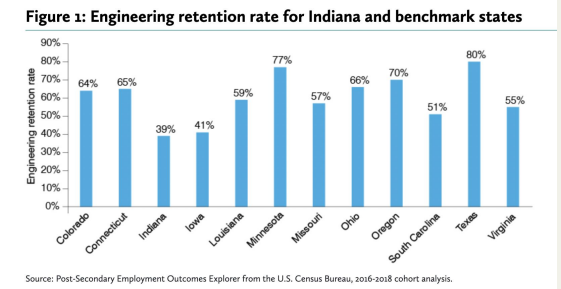
Mission Alignment

- Addressing Indiana’s workforce misalignment inspires me.
- Ascend’s initiatives like the Ascend Network and talent development resonate with my vision for Indiana.

Opportunities for Impact

- Ascend helps retain talent in Indiana by creating pathways for students and professionals.
- I want to amplify these efforts to make Indiana a place of economic opportunity for all.

Indiana’s Workforce Challenges and Opportunities



Indiana Workforce Challenges:

- Brain Drain: Only 61% of Indiana college graduates with a bachelor's degree remain employed in the state one year after graduation, dropping to 55% after five years as many seek opportunities elsewhere.

- Talent Shortage: Indiana faces a significant skills gap, with 68% of employers struggling to find qualified candidates, particularly in engineering, technology, and healthcare.

- Field-Specific Issues: A high number of engineering graduates leave Indiana for work, reflecting a disconnect between local education and job market needs.

Opportunities for Growth:

- Strategic Location: Indiana's central position supports growth in logistics, manufacturing, and tech. (“Crossroads of America”)

- Affordable Living: Indiana's low cost of living is a key advantage for attracting talent.

- Educational Institutions: Home to top universities, but struggles to retain graduates.

- Tech Sector Growth: Growing tech ecosystem/startups, but scaling efforts are needed to attract and retain talent.

Potential for Impact with Ascend Indiana:

- With the Ascend Network currently reaching only 14 of 60 colleges/universities, there’s significant untapped potential to connect more students and graduates to Indiana opportunities

- Indiana’s emphasis on workforce development programs could bridge the skills gap if marketed effectively to both employers and job seekers.

Source: https://www.incontext.indiana.edu/2024/july-aug/article2.asp

My Previous Experiences

“What I Bring to the Table”

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCES

- Hub of China: Conducted market research and analytics to guide clients' entry into international markets, increasing engagement by 30%.

- 1st Source Bank: Used marketing analytics and regression analysis to create actionable insights, boosting campaign performance by 20%.

- WWF: Improved reporting processes to enhance data accessibility for over 20 teams in Southeast Asia.

- Skills: Proficient in tools like Power BI, Tableau, Google Analytics, Python, all Microsoft Office Suite and advanced techniques like customer segmentation, regression analysis, social media analytics, and data visualization.

How I Stand Out?

BACKGROUND

Passion for Workforce Development: As an international student, I deeply understand the value of job opportunities and workforce support.

Analytical Skills: My coursework and internships have equipped me with expertise in social media analytics, business analytics, and marketing.

Customer-Centric Mindset: I prioritize understanding user needs and creating targeted, impactful strategies.

Commitment to Indiana: I want to give back to a state that has given me so much, focusing on talent retention and development.

How I Can Help Ascend Indiana? Let’s drive growth together!

- **Data-Driven Insights:** Conducting user research to refine user personas for the Ascend Network.
- **Expanding Reach:** Strategizing to grow the Ascend Network beyond the 14 schools it currently reaches.
- **Marketing Strategies:** Creating targeted messaging frameworks to engage stakeholders like employers, students, and schools.
- **Social Media Analytics:** Utilizing tools to optimize campaigns, increase engagement, and communicate value effectively.

Ideas to Expand Ascend Network

- **Partnerships with more Universities:**

  Build stronger connections with underrepresented colleges (e.g., my university).

- **Student Ambassadors:** Create a program to promote Ascend Network in colleges and universities.

- **Social Media Campaigns:** Highlight blog posts, success stories and opportunities on platforms like LinkedIn and Instagram. Sending regular newsletters

- **Interactive Content:** Develop workshops and webinars for career readiness to attract more students and employers.

Let’s Build Indiana Together!

I am passionate about Ascend Indiana’s mission and excited to contribute to its growth. Let’s collaborate to make Indiana a thriving hub of opportunity and talent!

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